



Questionnaire: Tony White Group - Sharton Motors dealerships in Maitland, Port Stephens and Cardiff

MN-05017

Deadline to respond: 20 May 2026

The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (**ACCC**) is currently assessing TWG Hunter Dealerships Pty Ltd (**TWG Hunter Dealerships**)'s proposed acquisition of 95% of the share capital of Sharton Motors Pty Ltd (**Sharton Motors**), and the land on which Sharton Motors' dealerships are operated (together, the **Acquisition**).

Sharton Motors operates four dealerships in the Newcastle and Hunter Valley region of New South Wales (**NSW**), being:

- Maitland Toyota
- Port Stephens Toyota
- Hunter GWM
- Cardiff GWM.

TWG Hunter Dealerships is a special purpose vehicle associated with the Tony White Group (**TWG**). In the Newcastle and Hunter Valley region, TWG operates:

- Cardiff Motor Group (comprised of Cardiff Ford, Nissan, Hyundai, Chery and Volkswagen)
- Highways Group in Rutherford (comprised of Highway Ford and Hyundai)
- Kloster Motor Group in Newcastle (dealing Ford, Mitsubishi, Hyundai, Volkswagen, Nissan, Suzuki, Chery and various others).

For further information about the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition, see the ACCC's [Acquisitions Register](#).

The ACCC is assessing the impact of the Acquisition on competition and is seeking your views. The ACCC invites you to provide submissions or information in response to the questions below by 20 May 2026 via email to mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Submission re: Tony White Group - Sharton Motors*. The ACCC must complete its assessment within strict statutory timelines which also impacts the time available for consultation.

If you would prefer to speak to a member of the ACCC case team, please email mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Request for call re: Tony White Group - Sharton Motors*. Someone from the case team will contact you to find a suitable time for a call.

Please note that:

- This request is made in accordance with section 51ABZZD(2)(a) and (c) of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) (the **Act**). This means that while the ACCC may take into account submissions or information received after the due date, it is not required to do so.
- In responding to the questions below or when providing a submission, please highlight and/or mark any confidential information and indicate why the information is confidential (as brief reasons in footnotes in your response or submission, or in a separate document such as the ACCC's [confidentiality claims template](#)). The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are outlined at the end of this document.

In this questionnaire:

OEM refers to the Original Equipment Manufacturer of vehicle brands operating in Australia, such as Toyota or Mitsubishi.

Independent Repairers refers to businesses that repair and service cars but are not affiliated with or owned by a car dealership.

Questions

Question for all respondents

1. Provide a brief description of your business or organisation, including any commercial relationships you have with TWG operated dealerships, or Sharton Group operated dealerships.

2. Outline any concerns regarding the impact of the Acquisition on competition, including if any of the Sharton Motors sites are close competitors with TWG sites, or if there is only a small number of competing dealership groups in the area.

3. Provide any additional information or comments that you consider relevant to the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition.

Questions for new car dealerships

4. Identify the dealerships you compete against (at the dealership group or OEM brand level). Specify the OEM brands that each competitor represents. As part of your response, explain what makes them strong competitors to you (e.g. price, range, proximity, service levels).

5. For any new car dealerships you operate in the Newcastle/Hunter Valley region, specify the distances or areas your customers travel to purchase a new car. If known, please provide percentages of customers travelling 0-10km, 10-20km, 20-30km and 30-40km to purchase a new car.

6. To what extent do dealerships offering different OEM brands compete? Which brands compete against each of the Toyota and GWM/Haval brands?

7. If your dealership offers servicing and repairs, to what extent do you compete with Independent Repairers in the supply of these services? Explain how the level of competition may differ for (i) cars within OEM warranty periods (ii) cars outside OEM warranty periods, and (iii) cars with capped price servicing.

8. For any servicing and repair sites you operate in the Newcastle/Hunter Valley region, specify the distances or areas your customers travel for car servicing and repairs. If known, please provide percentages of customers travelling 0-10km, 10-20km, 20-30km and 30-40km to obtain car servicing and repairs.

If you do not operate any car servicing and repair sites in the area, please respond to the above based on other sites you operate in surrounding areas.

Confidentiality of responses

During the ACCC's assessment of a notified acquisition, the ACCC may receive information that is properly regarded as being confidential, and which is provided to the ACCC in confidence. The ACCC is committed to treating this information responsibly and in accordance with the law. The ACCC understands the importance of confidentiality to parties involved in a notified acquisition, as well as to third parties that provide information to the ACCC.

The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are:

- there is no restriction on the internal use, including future use, that the ACCC may make of the confidential information consistent with the ACCC's statutory functions
- confidential information may be disclosed to the ACCC's external advisors and consultants on condition that each such advisor or consultant will be informed of the obligation to treat the information as confidential, and
- the ACCC may disclose the confidential information to other third parties if compelled by law or in accordance with section 155AAA of the Act. This includes disclosures made in the performance of official duties or functions, which include transparency requirements which are part of the merger control regime.

For further information on confidentiality, see the ACCC's [interim merger process guidelines](#).